

Office Communicator 2010

The beta version which includes the Wave 14 package comes out this March

Steve dislikes Flash

Steve Jobs doesn't like Adobe Flash because it's too heavy



ADOBE® AIR™

Feel the Air

Learn how to build rich internet applications based on Adobe Integrated Runtime platform, and deliver them across most operating systems

Rahil Banthia

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

The Adobe Integrated Runtime (Air), is a cross platform runtime. Basically, it's a wrapper for rich internet applications to be installed on several operating systems. It's freely available, and you can download it from the Adobe web site just like the Flash Player. You will get rich and engaging visuals from the applications you create for Adobe Air as it includes a lot of built-in graphic capabilities. Also the applications will run on Windows, Linux and Mac machines with little or no code modification

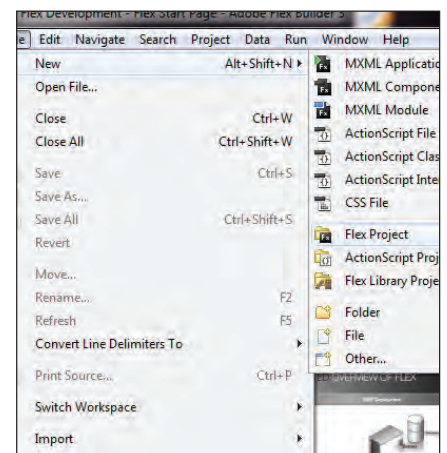


on your part. Finally, your users will also enjoy a quick and simple installation through Adobe Air runtime.

You can build Air applications using HTML and JavaScript which are then rendered inside an Air application using the open source web-kit HTML and JavaScript engine. So, you can use a HTML editor such as Dreamweaver or Notepad to create Air applications. You can also build Air applications using the Adobe Flex Builder, which is exactly what we will do in this article. While Flex is traditionally used to build Flex applications for the browser, the Air SDK that has been added into Flex recently gives you more features that are specific to Adobe Air.

Air vs. Flash

Air and Flash are both Virtual machines (commonly referred to as ActionScript virtual machine) like Java, but Air adds more access to the underlying operating system when compared to Flash, so developers can interact with the operating system's dock, or



To create a new project, click on File > New > Flex Project

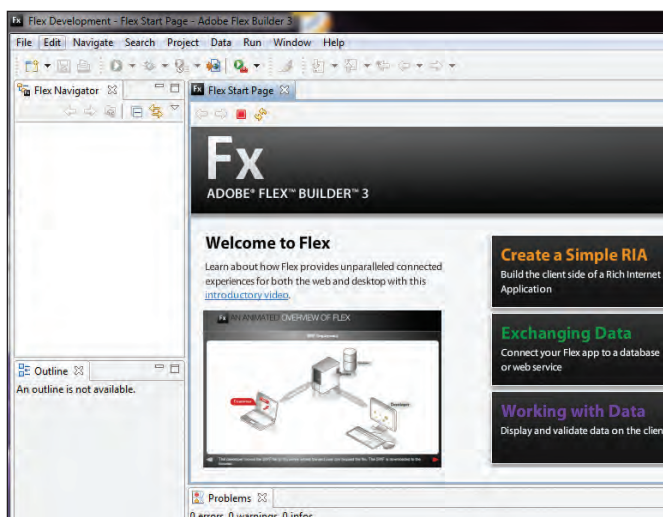
start menu or taskbar in addition to files, network connections and more. Unlike Flash applications, Air applications are packaged into installers and run like other 'traditional applications' without the need of a web browser.

Getting started

We will create a simple desktop application for Adobe Air using the Adobe Flex Builder IDE which will use Air user interface controls and validation. Along the way, we will delve into Action Script 3, one of the programming languages you can use for creating Air applications with Flex Builder and some advanced Air functionality.

Prerequisites

You'll need to install Adobe Flex builder available at <http://www.adobe.com/products/flex/> and on this month's DVD.



The Flex Builder user interface